

Ben Akoka

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara

Santa Barbara, CA

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Statistics and Data Science

September 2024 – Present

- Expected graduation – June 2027; GPA: 3.89
- Honors Program; Technology Management Program
- Relevant Coursework: Probability & Statistics, Statistical Modeling, Linear Algebra, Intermediate Python, Regression Analysis

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages (by proficiency): R, SQL, Python
- Tools: Excel, Google Sheets, Looker Studio, Claude/OpenAI/Gemini APIs, BigQuery, Google Search Console

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Insomniac Events

Calabasas, CA

Data & AI Analytics Specialist

August 2026 – Present

- Architect a centralized database platform consolidating Insomniac's festival data into a single system with task assignment, permission controls, and automated data-collection reminders; presenting progress and roadmap directly to senior executives.
- Enable downstream analytics on the unified platform, including interactive dashboards, AI chatbots, and AI-driven recommenders, replacing fragmented manual reporting across teams.
- Serve as technical liaison between Insomniac's marketing team and an external data partner, using SQL and BigQuery to clean and consolidate marketing data feeding into the broader platform.

Taboola, Inc.

Remote

Data Analyst & SEO Strategy Intern

June 2025 – September 2025

- Analyzed 200+ webpages across Taboola's AI, seasonal, and marketing hub domains to identify content performance trends, keyword opportunities, and SEO optimization strategies across diverse content categories.
- Conducted competitive benchmarking and keyword research across 12+ competitors to uncover search gaps, evaluate ranking performance, and develop recommendations to improve organic visibility.
- Built and presented 8+ strategy reports using Google Search Console, Looker Studio, Ahrefs, internal analytics tools, and emerging AI search analytics platforms to translate SEO and AI visibility data into actionable recommendations for stakeholders.

UCSB Center for AI and Society

Santa Barbara, CA

Undergraduate AI Research Assistant

August 2026 – Present

- Conducting research with Professor David Lawson on gender-biased drift in human and AI cultural transmission, using a transmission-chain paradigm across 430+ chains to test stereotype-reinforcing bias in AI-generated rewrites.
- Built a custom attribution rating tool and integrated ChatGPT and Gemini APIs to collect and evaluate AI-generated outputs, designing the underlying data schema and handling model-versioning and output-parsing edge cases.
- Contributing to literature review, experimental design, and IRB preparation; designing the R analysis pipeline for hypothesis testing.

TAMID Group

Santa Barbara, CA

Project Manager

January 2025 – Present

- Lead a 7-person project team conducting market research, customer segmentation, and competitive analysis for GLOW AI, an AI-driven relationship startup.
- Ran surveys and user interviews to evaluate product-market fit, identifying a strategic shift from an AI relationship-coaching tool toward an AI matchmaking product, a pivot adopted into the company's product direction.

UC Santa Barbara Tour Guide Association

Santa Barbara, CA

Campus Tour Guide

January 2026 – Present

- Deliver 50+ campus tours to hundreds of prospective students and families, including Open House events, through engaging, personalized storytelling.
- Adapt tour content and delivery to each group's interests (e.g., STEM vs. humanities, transfer students) to resonate with varied audiences.

Heschel Day School

Northridge, CA

IT Technician

June 2022 – September 2024

- Repaired and maintained school hardware (laptops, projectors, tablets, including component-level replacements), provided faculty tech support, and produced marketing graphics and videos.

PROJECTS

"How Rare Are You?" – benakoka.com/names

July 2026

- Built and deployed a web app analyzing name rarity using Social Security Administration data, actuarial survival weighting, and Kaplan-Meier survival curves; reached 8,000+ lifetime visitors.